Remote working IT guide

Article KB0010088 | Owner: Network Support | Subcategory: General | Applies to: Windows 11 laptops (Dell Latitude 5440/7440, Lenovo ThinkPad T14/X1 Carbon, HP EliteBook 840), macOS 14/15 MacBook Pro/Air, Mobile devices using Microsoft Authenticator, Palo Alto GlobalProtect VPN, ACME-Corp and ACME-Guest Wi-Fi networks, Microsoft 365 services (Outlook, Teams, OneDrive, SharePoint)

Summary

This guide helps Acme Global employees work securely from any location using company-provided laptops, VPN, Wi-Fi, and Microsoft 365 services. It outlines common connectivity issues, quick self-help checks, and the steps the IT Service Desk (L1) and Network Support teams follow to resolve remote-working problems.

Symptoms

- Unable to launch GlobalProtect or connection times out
- VPN connects but no access to internal resources (file shares, intranet)
- Wi-Fi shows "ACME-Corp" but authentication fails with 802.1X error
- MFA push notification not received or denied
- Outlook/Teams shows "Cannot connect to server" or "Your organization's data cannot be accessed"
- Print jobs stall in PaperCut queue when off-site

Common causes

- Misconfigured or expired GlobalProtect client certificate
- Local ISP blocking UDP 4500/500 or TCP 443 used by GlobalProtect
- Wi-Fi profile missing machine certificate or using wrong SSID
- Conditional Access policies requiring MFA or compliant device not met
- Expired password or lockout after failed attempts
- Split-tunneling routes preventing traffic to internal DNS servers

Preparation - Verify Device Readiness

Before attempting to connect remotely, ensure the laptop is powered on, running the latest Windows 11 or macOS build, and that the Company Portal app shows all required applications as installed. Confirm that BitLocker (Windows) or FileVault (macOS) is enabled and that the device is compliant in Intune (no pending compliance actions).

Self-Help Connectivity Procedure

Follow these steps to troubleshoot the most common remote-access issues. Each step builds on the previous one; stop when you regain access to internal resources.

1. 1. Check internet access: open a browser and try to reach a public site (e.g., https://www.google.com). If this fails, troubleshoot your home ISP or router before proceeding.
2. 2. Verify Wi-Fi/Ethernet: ensure you are connected to either "ACME-Corp" (preferred) or a trusted home network. If using "ACME-Corp", disconnect and reconnect to trigger 802.1X re-authentication.
3. 3. Launch GlobalProtect from the system tray (Windows) or menu bar (macOS). Note any error message displayed in the client window.
4. 4. If the client reports "Certificate invalid" or "Failed to establish tunnel", open the Company Portal, navigate to Devices -> your laptop -> Check compliance, and renew the VPN certificate if prompted (certificates renew yearly).
5. 5. Attempt to connect again. If successful, test access to an internal resource such as the intranet homepage (https://intranet.acme.example) or a file share via File Explorer -> \\fileserver\share.
6. 6. If the VPN connects but internal resources remain unreachable, flush DNS (ipconfig /flushdns on Windows, sudo dscacheutil -flushcache on macOS) and try again.
7. 7. Should you still encounter issues, collect the GlobalProtect log (Help -> Export Log) and note any error codes before contacting the Service Desk.

Service-Desk Agent Procedure

When a user reports a remote-working issue, follow this structured workflow to diagnose and resolve the problem

efficiently. Document each step in the ticket.

1. 1. Validate identity: confirm the user's employee ID and that they have successfully authenticated via MFA (Authenticator push or SMS).
2. 2. Confirm baseline connectivity: ask the user to test a public website; if this fails, advise ISP/router troubleshooting and close the ticket as a non-IT issue.
3. 3. Review GlobalProtect status: request a screenshot of the client window or the exported log. Look for certificate errors, authentication failures, or timeout messages.
4. 4. If certificate-related, verify the device's compliance status in Intune and check the VPN certificate expiry date; if expired, guide the user to renew via Company Portal or push a new certificate through Intune.
5. 5. For authentication failures, ensure the user's password is not expired or locked out (check Entra ID sign-in logs). If needed, initiate a self-service password reset or issue a Temporary Access Pass via the IAM team.
6. 6. Examine Conditional Access policies: confirm the device is marked compliant and that the user satisfies any MFA or location-based requirements.
7. 7. Test internal name resolution: have the user ping an internal DNS name (e.g., intranet.acme.example) and compare the result to pinging an external name; discrepancies indicate split-tunneling or DNS-forwarding issues.
8. 8. If all checks pass and the problem persists, escalate to Network Support with the collected logs, screenshot, and a summary of steps already performed.

Verification and Closure

After applying the fix, ask the user to perform the following validation steps before closing the ticket. Successful verification ensures the issue is truly resolved and reduces repeat contacts.

1. 1. Re-launch GlobalProtect and confirm the connection status shows "Connected" with a green indicator.
2. 2. Access at least two distinct internal resources (e.g., intranet homepage and a shared folder) to verify end-to-end connectivity.
3. 3. Send a test Teams message or make a Teams call to a colleague to confirm real-time collaboration works.
4. 4. Attempt to print a test document using PaperCut secure release; confirm the job releases after tapping the ID badge at a nearby printer.
5. 5. If any step fails, repeat the troubleshooting flow or escalate as needed.

When to escalate

Escalate to the Network Support team when: the user cannot establish a GlobalProtect tunnel after certificate renewal and basic connectivity checks; DNS or split-tunneling issues persist after flushing DNS and verifying routing; or the problem appears to affect multiple users from the same geographic area, suggesting a regional ISP or VPN gateway issue. Include in the escalation: user ID, device hostname, GlobalProtect log excerpt, screenshots of error messages, results of internal/external ping tests, and a summary of all self-help and service-desk steps already attempted.

Keywords: remote work, VPN, GlobalProtect, Wi-Fi, ACME-Corp, MFA, password reset, Intune compliance, BitLocker, FileVault, PaperCut, split tunneling, DNS flush, conditional access